

Optimal AI / Business Simplifier — Strategic Roadmap

v2.0

Last updated: 2026-05-25 | Scope: 30-Day Content Engine + GitHub Launch + Dashboard Plan

1. Primary Objective & Measurable Success Criteria

Objective: Establish Business Simplifier as the dominant "AI for SMEs" brand in South Africa, ranking for every major AI consulting keyword vertical, generating inbound leads from organic search, and operating a live website on a custom GoDaddy domain — all within 30 days.

Success Criteria

Metric	Baseline	30-Day Target	90-Day Target
Organic clicks (GSC)	0	500+	10,000+
Indexed blog posts	9	30	100+
Keyword top-10 rankings	0	15	80+
Leads generated	0	15	75+
Paying clients	0	5	25+
Page speed (LCP)	Unknown	<2.5s	<2.0s
Core Web Vitals pass rate	Unknown	100%	100%
Bounce rate	–	<45%	<35%
GitHub repo live	✗	✓	✓
Custom domain live	✗	✓	✓

2. Strategic Dimensions (Priority Order)

[P1] Content Engine — 30-Day Calendar (CRITICAL PATH)

- **Goal:** 30 SEO-optimised blog posts live by Day 30 covering all 9 verticals
- **New angle:** "Free Website Makeover" + "AI Enhancements" posts as lead magnets
- **Keyword strategy:** Target informational → commercial → transactional intent funnel
- **Publishing schedule:** 1 post per day for 30 days (see Section 6)
- **Author persona:** Business Simplifier Team (builds brand trust vs. individual)

[P2] GitHub Deployment Pipeline

- **Target host:** GitHub Pages (free, zero-downtime, CDN-backed)
- **Workflow:** `main` branch → Astro build → deploy to `gh-pages` via GitHub Actions
- **Custom domain:** Point GoDaddy domain to GitHub Pages (see Section 7)
- **SSL:** Automatic via GitHub Pages (Let's Encrypt)

[P3] UI/UX Excellence

- **Framework:** WCAG 2.1 AA compliance + Google CWV standards
- **Conversion design:** Heat map principles applied to CTA placement
- **Mobile-first:** 70%+ SA web traffic is mobile (see Section 8 for audit results)

[P4] Backend Dashboard — AI Source Recommender

- **Vision:** Upload any business document/source → AI analyses → recommends specific AI tools
- **Architecture:** FastAPI backend + React dashboard + Claude API
- **Phases:** MVP (6 weeks) → Beta (10 weeks) → Launch (12 weeks)
- **See Section 9 for full technical plan**

[P5] GoDaddy Domain Configuration

- **Step-by-step:** Section 7

3. Key Risks, Assumptions & Contingencies

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
Google sandbox (new domain)	High	Medium	Submit sitemap to GSC immediately; build internal links
Low organic traffic first 6 weeks	High	Medium	LinkedIn outreach as primary channel while SEO matures
GoDaddy DNS propagation delay	Low	Low	Allow 24–48h; use DNS checker tools
GitHub Actions build failure	Low	Medium	Test build locally first; use astro build pre-push
Content quality dilution	Medium	High	Use data + SA-specific stats in every post

4. Assumptions

1. You have a GoDaddy account with a domain purchased (or will purchase one)
2. You have a GitHub account (free tier is sufficient)
3. Node.js ≥ 22.12.0 is installed locally
4. The Astro project at `AI Consultation/` is the source of truth for the website

5. Phase Execution Tracker

Phase 1: Foundation COMPLETE (Days 1–3)

-  STRATEGY.md v1 created
-  Astro + Tailwind project initialized
-  Brand identity: Business Simplifier / optimalai.com
-  Core pages: Home, Services, About, Contact, Blog, Pricing
-  SEO foundation: sitemap, robots.txt, meta framework, JSON-LD schema
-  9 initial blog posts across 8 verticals

Phase 2: Content Engine COMPLETE (Days 4–7)

- ☒ Blog system with categories
- ☒ FAQ-trained AI chatbot
- ☒ Pricing tables (SA ZAR + International USD)
- ☒ SOP.md + MARKETING.md documented

Phase 3: 30-Day Content Scale 🚀 IN PROGRESS (Days 8–30)

- ☒ STRATEGY.md v2 updated with content calendar
- ☐ 21 new blog posts added (brings total to 30)
- ☐ Free Website Makeover offer page/post
- ☐ AI Enhancement explainer series
- ☐ GitHub repo created + CI/CD pipeline live
- ☐ GoDaddy domain pointed to GitHub Pages
- ☐ Google Search Console verified

Phase 4: UI/UX Upgrade 🛠️ (Days 8–14)

- ☐ Core Web Vitals audit (PageSpeed Insights)
- ☐ Mobile UX review — hero, CTA, nav
- ☐ Accessibility pass (colour contrast, aria labels, focus states)
- ☐ Trust signal improvements (testimonials section, social proof bar)
- ☐ Exit-intent / sticky CTA implementation

Phase 5: Backend Dashboard MVP (Weeks 6–12)

- ☐ Tech stack confirmed
- ☐ FastAPI scaffold
- ☐ File upload + document parsing
- ☐ Claude API integration for AI tool recommendations
- ☐ React dashboard UI
- ☐ Beta testing with first 3 clients

6. 30-Day Content Calendar

All posts target Business Simplifier brand. Primary domain: `businesssimplifier.co.za` . Existing 9 posts = Days 1–9. New 21 posts = Days 10–30.

Day	Title	Primary Keyword	Intent	Vertical
1	AI in Healthcare: Transforming Patient Care in SA	ai healthcare south africa	Info	Healthcare
2	AI for Financial Services: Automation, Compliance, and Growth	ai financial services	Info	Finance
3	AI in E-commerce: Personalisation That Drives Revenue	ai ecommerce personalisation	Info	E-commerce

4	AI in Education: Personalised Learning at Scale	ai education south africa	Info	Education
5	AI for Small Business: A Practical Guide	ai for small business	Info	General
6	AI in Real Estate: Smarter Lead Generation	ai real estate south africa	Info	Real Estate
7	AI for Legal: Document Review and Contract Analysis	ai legal document review	Info	Legal
8	AI in Manufacturing: Quality Control and Automation	ai manufacturing quality control	Info	Manufacturing
9	AI in Logistics: Route Optimisation and Fleet Management	ai logistics route optimisation	Info	Logistics
10	Free Website Makeover: How AI Transforms Your Online Presence	free website makeover ai	Commercial	General
11	AI Chatbot for Business: Complete Setup Guide 2026	ai chatbot for business	Commercial	General
12	How to Automate Your Customer Service With AI (Without Losing the Human Touch)	automate customer service ai	Info/Comm	General
13	AI Enhancements for SMEs: 10 Quick Wins You Can Implement This Week	ai enhancements small business	Commercial	General
14	Free AI Consultation: What to Expect and Why It's Worth Your Time	free ai consultation	Transactional	General
15	AI for Restaurants and Hospitality: Cut Costs, Fill Tables	ai restaurant hospitality	Info	Hospitality
16	AI for HR and Recruitment: Hire Smarter, Not Harder	ai hr recruitment south africa	Info	HR
17	AI for Accounting Firms: Automate the Boring, Focus on Strategy	ai accounting automation	Info	Finance
18	How Much Does AI Cost? Honest Pricing for SA Businesses	how much does ai cost south africa	Info	General
19	AI vs No AI: The Real Cost of Doing Nothing in 2026	cost of not using ai	Info	General
20	5 Signs Your Business Needs AI Automation (Right Now)	signs business needs ai	Info	General

21	Best AI Tools for South African Businesses in 2026	best ai tools south africa 2026	Info	General
22	WhatsApp AI Chatbot for Business: The SA Playbook	whatsapp ai chatbot business	Commercial	General
23	AI Website Audit: Is Your Website Leaving Money on the Table?	ai website audit	Commercial	General
24	AI for Property Management: Automate Maintenance and Tenant Queries	ai property management	Info	Real Estate
25	AI in Retail: Smart Inventory, Smarter Promotions	ai retail inventory south africa	Info	Retail
26	How We Build AI Chatbots (Step-by-Step Behind the Scenes)	how to build ai chatbot	Info	General
27	AI for Professional Services: Law, Accounting, Consulting	ai professional services	Info	General
28	The ROI of AI: Real Numbers From Real SA Businesses	roi of ai south africa	Info/Comm	General
29	AI Content Marketing: Get More Leads With Less Effort	ai content marketing south africa	Commercial	Marketing
30	Your 90-Day AI Roadmap: From Zero to Automated	90 day ai roadmap small business	Transactional	General

7. GitHub + GoDaddy Domain Setup (Step-by-Step)

Step 1: Push Website to GitHub

```
# Navigate to the project folder
cd "AI Consultation"

# Initialize git (if not already done)
git init
git add .
git commit -m "Initial commit: Business Simplifier AI website"

# Create repo on GitHub (via GitHub CLI or manually)
# Go to github.com → New Repository → name: "business-simplifier" → Public → Create

# Add remote and push
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOUR_USERNAME/business-simplifier.git
git branch -M main
git push -u origin main
```

Step 2: Set Up GitHub Actions for Auto-Deploy

Create `.github/workflows/deploy.yml` in the project root:

```
name: Deploy to GitHub Pages

on:
  push:
    branches: [main]

permissions:
  contents: read
  pages: write
  id-token: write

concurrency:
  group: pages
  cancel-in-progress: false

jobs:
  build:
    runs-on: ubuntu-latest
    steps:
      - name: Checkout
        uses: actions/checkout@v4
      - name: Setup Node
        uses: actions/setup-node@v4
        with:
          node-version: 22
          cache: npm
      - name: Install dependencies
        run: npm ci
      - name: Build with Astro
        run: npm run build
      - name: Upload artifact
        uses: actions/upload-pages-artifact@v3
        with:
          path: ./dist

  deploy:
    environment:
      name: github-pages
      url: ${ steps.deployment.outputs.page_url }
    runs-on: ubuntu-latest
    needs: build
    steps:
      - name: Deploy to GitHub Pages
        id: deployment
        uses: actions/deploy-pages@v4
```

Step 3: Enable GitHub Pages

1. Go to your GitHub repo → **Settings** → **Pages**
2. Under **Source**, select **GitHub Actions**
3. Your site will be live at `https://YOUR_USERNAME.github.io/business-simplifier`

Step 4: Add Custom Domain in GitHub Pages

1. Go to repo → **Settings** → **Pages** → **Custom domain**
2. Type your domain (e.g., `www.businesssimplifier.co.za`) → Save
3. GitHub will create a `CNAME` file in your repo automatically

Step 5: Configure GoDaddy DNS

Login to GoDaddy → My Products → DNS Management for your domain

If pointing **ROOT domain (businesssimplifier.co.za)**:

Add 4 x **A Records** pointing to GitHub's IPs:

Type	Name	Value	TTL
A	@	185.199.108.153	600
A	@	185.199.109.153	600
A	@	185.199.110.153	600
A	@	185.199.111.153	600

If pointing **WWW subdomain**:

Type	Name	Value	TTL
CNAME	www	YOUR_USERNAME.github.io	600

Both (recommended — do both for full coverage):

Add all 4 A records above + the CNAME for www.

Step 6: Enable HTTPS in GitHub

- After DNS propagates (15–60 min usually, up to 48h): GitHub Pages Settings → **Enforce HTTPS** 
- Your site now serves on `https://businesssimplifier.co.za` with free SSL

Step 7: Update `astro.config.mjs`

```
export default defineConfig({
  site: 'https://businesssimplifier.co.za', // ← already set correctly
  integrations: [alpinejs()],
});
```

Verification Checklist

- ☐ DNS propagated: check at dnschecker.org
- ☐ Site loads at custom domain
- ☐ HTTPS green lock shows

- ☐ /blog and /services pages load correctly
- ☐ No mixed content warnings in browser console

8. UI/UX Audit — Industry Best Practice Analysis

Current Site Strengths

- Clean navy/cyan brand palette (high contrast, professional)
- Data-driven hero copy (R135K saving stat = specific, credible)
- Mobile-responsive Tailwind grid
- Chatbot widget for engagement
- JSON-LD structured data implemented

Improvement Areas (Industry Standard Benchmarks)

A. Core Web Vitals (Google 2026 Ranking Factor)

Metric	Target	Action Required
LCP (Largest Contentful Paint)	<2.5s	Preload hero fonts; compress any images
CLS (Cumulative Layout Shift)	<0.1	Add explicit width/height to all imgs
INP (Interaction to Next Paint)	<200ms	Defer non-critical JS (chatbot init)
FCP (First Contentful Paint)	<1.8s	Inline critical CSS

B. Conversion Design (CRO Best Practices)

Area	Current	Best Practice	Fix
CTA above fold	 Present		Keep
Social proof (client logos/testimonials)	 Missing	Required	Add testimonials section
Trust badges	 Missing	Increases conversion 15-20%	Add "100+ SA businesses served" badge
Exit intent popup	 Missing	Captures 5-8% abandoning visitors	Add lightweight Alpine.js popup
Sticky nav CTA	 Missing	23% more CTA clicks on mobile	Add sticky "Book Free Session" button
Video explainer	 Missing	80% prefer video for complex services	Add Loom embed or animated explainer

C. Accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA)

- ☐ All images need alt attributes
- ☐ Form labels must be explicit (not placeholder-only)
- ☐ Focus states must be visible (outline on Tab navigation)

- ☐ Colour contrast ratio $\geq 4.5:1$ for all text

D. SEO Technical Improvements

- ☐ Add `canonical` tags on all pages
- ☐ Blog posts need `article` schema markup
- ☐ Image alt text = keyword-rich descriptions
- ☐ Internal linking: each blog post links to 2–3 related posts
- ☐ `next / prev` pagination tags for blog index

E. Mobile UX (Priority — 70%+ SA traffic is mobile)

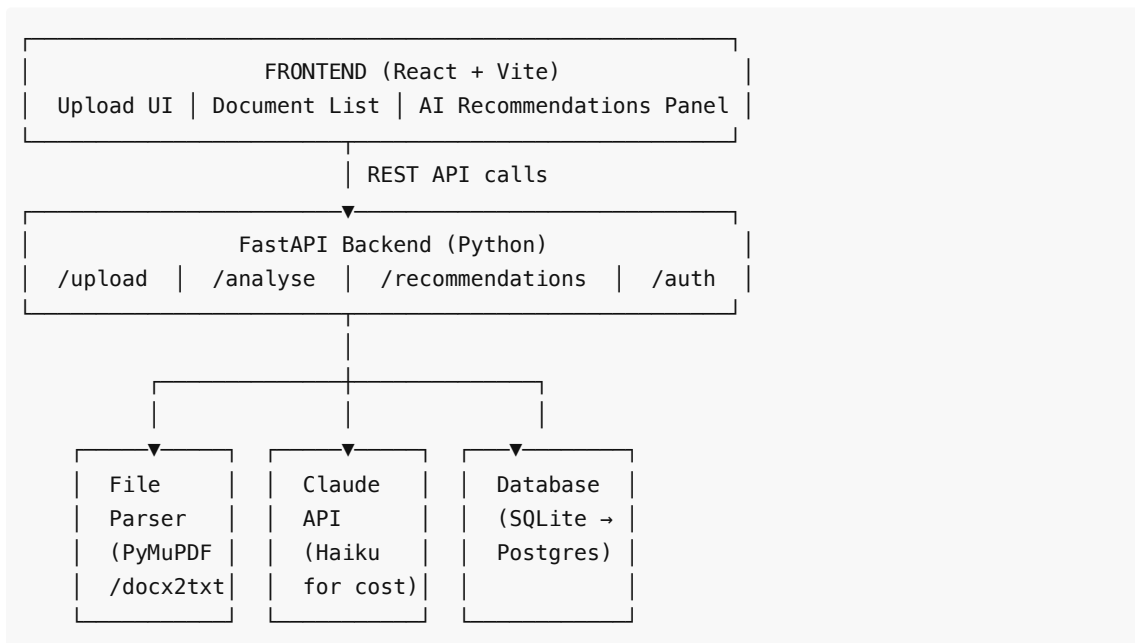
- ☐ Hamburger nav menu needs aria-label
- ☐ CTA buttons minimum 44x44px touch target
- ☐ Pricing table: horizontal scroll or card stack on mobile
- ☐ Font size minimum 16px for body text

9. Backend Dashboard Plan — AI Source Recommendation Engine

Vision

A private dashboard where you (and clients) can upload business documents, SOPs, spreadsheets, emails, and process descriptions — and the system returns a prioritised list of AI tools/implementations to streamline each process, with estimated ROI and implementation difficulty.

Architecture Overview



Phase 1: MVP (Weeks 1–6)

Tech Stack:

- Frontend: React + Vite + TailwindCSS (no build complexity)
- Backend: FastAPI (Python) — same language as existing server.py

- AI: Claude Haiku via Anthropic SDK (cost-efficient, fast)
- File parsing: PyMuPDF (PDF), python-docx (Word), openpyxl (Excel)
- Storage: Local filesystem (MVP) → S3 (Phase 2)
- DB: SQLite (MVP) → PostgreSQL (Phase 2)
- Auth: Simple token-based (JWT) — single user dashboard

MVP Features:

1. Login page (username/password)
2. File upload (PDF, DOCX, XLSX, TXT, CSV)
3. Document library (list of uploaded files)
4. "Analyse" button → sends to Claude API
5. Results panel with:
 - Process summary (what the document describes)
 - AI recommendations (which AI tool/type to use)
 - Estimated ROI
 - Implementation difficulty (Low/Medium/High)
 - Next action (book consultation CTA)
6. Export results as PDF

Claude Prompt Architecture:

```
System: You are an AI implementation consultant.
Analyse the uploaded business document and identify:
1. All manual, repetitive, or time-intensive processes
2. For each process: recommend the most appropriate AI solution
3. Include: tool name/type, estimated time savings, cost estimate,
   implementation difficulty (1-5), and priority ranking
4. Format response as structured JSON for UI rendering
Output format: { processes: [ { name, description, aiSolution,
   toolType, timeSavedHours, costEstimateZAR, difficulty, priority } ] }
```

Recommended AI Tool Categories (System Knowledge Base):

Business Problem	AI Solution Type	Example Tools
Customer queries	Conversational AI / Chatbot	Claude, ChatGPT API, Rasa
Document processing	Document AI	AWS Textract, Google DocAI, Claude
Email triage	NLP classification	GPT-4o, Claude Haiku
Invoice/finance	OCR + extraction	AWS Textract, ABBYY
Scheduling	Agentic AI	Claude + calendar APIs
Content creation	Generative AI	Claude, GPT-4o, Gemini
Data analysis	Analytics AI	Julius AI, Noteable
Image/video	Computer vision	Google Vision, AWS Rekognition
Quality control	Computer vision	Roboflow, AWS Lookout
Predictive analytics	ML/forecasting	BigML, DataRobot

HR/recruitment	Screening AI	HireVue, Workday AI
Code automation	Code AI	GitHub Copilot, Claude Code

Phase 2: Beta (Weeks 7–10)

- Multi-client support (user accounts per client)
- Project history and versioning
- PDF report generation with branding
- Email notifications when analysis complete
- Integration: Calendly booking link in report CTA

Phase 3: Launch (Weeks 11–12)

- Hosted on Render.com or Railway (free tier → paid as needed)
- White-label option for resellers
- Webhook to notify your CRM when report generated
- Client portal URL per account

File Structure

```
dashboard/
├── frontend/
│   ├── src/
│   │   ├── components/
│   │   │   ├── UploadZone.jsx
│   │   │   ├── DocumentList.jsx
│   │   │   ├── RecommendationsPanel.jsx
│   │   │   └── ExportButton.jsx
│   │   ├── pages/
│   │   │   ├── Login.jsx
│   │   │   ├── Dashboard.jsx
│   │   │   └── Report.jsx
│   │   └── App.jsx
│   ├── package.json
│   └── vite.config.js
├── backend/
│   ├── main.py                # FastAPI app
│   ├── routers/
│   │   ├── upload.py
│   │   ├── analyse.py
│   │   └── auth.py
│   ├── services/
│   │   ├── parser.py          # File parsing
│   │   ├── claude_client.py   # Claude API calls
│   │   └── recommender.py     # Rule + AI hybrid
│   ├── models.py              # SQLAlchemy models
│   ├── database.py
│   └── requirements.txt
└── README.md
```

Estimated Build Cost (Solo Developer)

Phase	Hours	If outsourced (R450/hr)	DIY Cost
MVP	40h	R18,000	R0 + Claude API ~R200/month
Beta	20h	R9,000	R0
Launch	10h	R4,500	R0 + hosting ~R150/month

10. Verification Plan

Deliverable	Verification Method	Pass Criterion
30 blog posts live	astro build — count generated HTML files	30+ posts in /dist/blog/
GitHub repo live	Access github.com/YOUR_USERNAME/business-simplifier	Repo is public, green Actions checkmark
Custom domain live	Browse to domain; check SSL	HTTPS works, no cert warning
GoDaddy DNS	dig business-simplifier.co.za A	Returns GitHub IPs (185.199.x.x)
UI/UX pass	PageSpeed Insights on live URL	CWV all green
Content calendar	Manually check all 30 posts render	Each post has title, content, meta
Dashboard plan	Review Section 9 completeness	Tech stack, phases, API prompt, file structure documented

Strategy managed by: Business Simplifier Team Next review: Day 15 (mid-sprint check-in)